

CMS.100: Assignment 1, Data collection protocol

- 1) **Data set:** What is your data set about? What gap is it filling?
- 2) **Unit of observation:** what is one row of data? What does each number or observation represent? What kind of data is it (e.g., continuous, categorical, etc)?
 - a) Tidy data (Wickham 2014): each variable is a column, each observation is a row, and each observational unit is a table
- 3) **Inclusion criteria:** what belongs in the dataset?
- 4) **Exclusion criteria:** what would be excluded from the dataset?
- 5) **Measuring instrument:** how are you collecting the data? With what?
- 6) **Scope:** how do you decide when a dataset starts and ends? What is the schedule or duration of your dataset?
- 7) **Missing data:** how are you dealing with missing, blank, null, etc. data? What does a blank, NA, or 0 mean in the context of your data?
- 8) **Storage:** file format? File name convention?
- 9) **Claims:** what kinds of arguments could you make with this data?